The Noble Sūtra That Thoroughly Pacifies Hemorrhoids

Ārya-arśapraśamani-sūtra · Toh 1020 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་གཞད་འབམ་རབ་ཏུ་ཞི་བར་བྱེད་པའོ།

The Noble Sūtra That Thoroughly Pacifies Hemorrhoids, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Arśapraśamanī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Zhangdrum Raptu Zhiwar Jepé Do, is a short Mahāyāna scripture that offers a healing incantation for relief from this painful affliction. The text opens at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, where the Buddha is seated before a great assembly of monks on the full-moon observance day, with the venerable Ānanda attending him and fanning him with a yak-tail fan before rising respectfully to put a question to him. Through this setting the sūtra frames the Buddha's teaching of protective words meant to cure physical illness, reflecting the practical concern for bodily well-being found in many Buddhist ritual texts. It is Toh 1020 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the collection of short works centered on spells and incantations for protection and healing.

In the Indian language: ārya arśapraśamani svāhā. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Sūtra That Thoroughly Pacifies Hemorrhoids.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, the grove where the kalandaka birds dwell, together with a great Saṅgha of about five hundred monks. Then, on the fifteenth-day poṣadha, the very day of the full moon, the Blessed One sat upon a seat that had been prepared before the Saṅgha.

At that time the venerable Ānanda was at the Blessed One's side, holding a yak-tail fan and fanning the Blessed One. Then the venerable Ānanda draped his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, and said to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, here in Rājagṛha many monks who have hemorrhoids are tormented by the affliction of hemorrhoids and are experiencing unbearable, intense, unpleasant and disagreeable feelings of suffering. Venerable Blessed One, how should I act on their behalf?"

When he had said this, the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, take up this sūtra that dispels hemorrhoids. Ānanda, whoever knows

the name, the words and the letters of this sūtra that dispels hemorrhoids will not be afflicted by the disease of hemorrhoids for as long as he lives. For seven lifetimes he will remember his former lives.

tadyathā alante alame śvalicinikuśi sambhava svāhā

"Ānanda, it is like this. In the north, on the king of mountains called the Himalaya, there is a sāla tree called Victorious, and it has three flowers. The first is called Growing, the second is called Soft, and the third is called Dried. Just as that one has dried up, so may the wind hemorrhoids of beings dry up. May the bile hemorrhoids dry up. May the phlegm hemorrhoids dry up. May the hemorrhoids of impurity dry up. May the blood hemorrhoids dry up. May the hemorrhoids of the combined humors dry up. Likewise, may the phlegm hemorrhoids of myself and of all beings dry up. May the hemorrhoids of impurity dry up. May the blood hemorrhoids dry up. May the hemorrhoids of the combined humors dry up. May the nasal growths dry up. May the hanging growths dry up.

tadyathā śame śamāne śame śamāne svāhā

"May they not ache. May they not stiffen. May they not make noise. May they not drip. May they not cause pain. May they not cause intense pain. May they not discharge. May they not discharge profusely. May they be exhausted right here, utterly exhausted, and be no more. Go beneath the earth!

namo bhagavate buddhāya satyavātīnaṃ siddhyantu mantrapadāni svāhā"

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The rite for this is as follows. This is accomplished by reciting it. Recite it seven times over a red thread, tie seven knots, and hang it around the neck.

The Noble Sūtra That Thoroughly Pacifies Hemorrhoids is complete.

This was translated, edited and finalized by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the chief editor-translator Bandé Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

• The name of the sāla tree, rendered literally as "Victorious," could not be confidently identified with a Sanskrit form. The three flower names are likewise translated by meaning. "Hemorrhoids" renders the Tibetan for Sanskrit arśas, a term that also covers other protruding growths, which is why the list includes nasal and hanging growths.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.